

How we define the sample & behavior windows

How Profile IQ usually builds audiences in **2025**, and what changes when we need more panelists to reach our minimum sample size.

Internal reference

Typical study year: 2025

Minimum Crosswalk respondents: 100,000

Two paths, one rule for behavior

Who we include in the profile (the sample) can widen backward in time if needed. **What** we count as engagement (behavior) stays inside the study year unless your run specifies otherwise. When we extend the panel to reach **100,000** for behavior, the **US projection** on the dashboard still reflects the **original study year**—not that larger behavioral sample.

MOST PROFILES

Standard window
Enough people were active in 2025 on their own.

- **Sample:** panelists active in **2025**
- **Behavior:** only their digital activity in **2025**
- Sample and behavior use the **same calendar window**

WHEN 2025 ALONE IS TOO SMALL

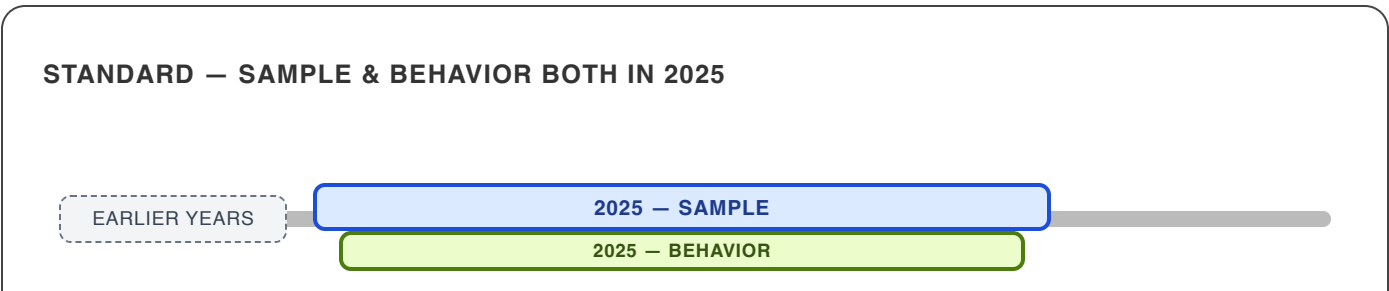
Extended recruitment
2025 might only yield e.g. 40k people—but we still need 100k for stable behavior modeling.

- **Behavior sample:** keep adding earlier cohorts (2024, 2023, ...) until we reach **≥ 100,000** panelists (2025 behaviors only)
- **US projection:** uses the **2025-only** audience size—the real count from the original year, *not* the 100k used for behavior
- Older panelists count for *membership*, not for pre-2025 behavior

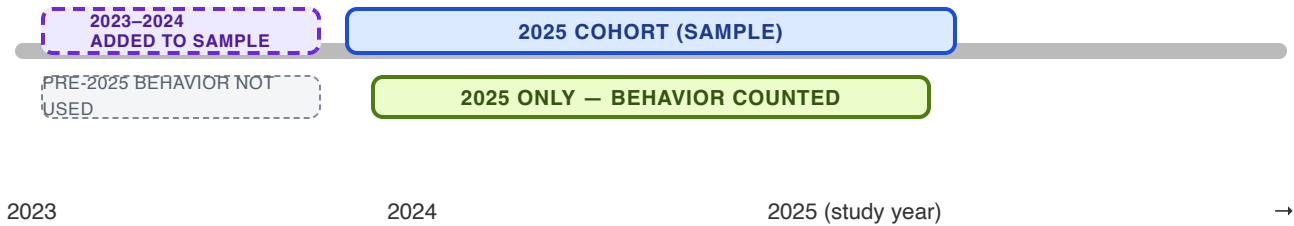
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Timeline view

The behavior window does not slide backward—only the pool of eligible panelists can.



EXTENDED RECRUITMENT — WIDER SAMPLE, BEHAVIOR STILL 2025 ONLY



We walk backward in time **only to find more people** until the behavioral sample hits **100,000** respondents. Their **qualifying behaviors** are still measured inside **2025**. The **US** number on the profile stays tied to how many people qualified in **2025 alone**.

CROSSWALK RESPONDENTS (DASHBOARD)

≥ 100,000

After extended recruitment—includes earlier-year panelists, but **2025 behavior only**. Used for stable % and index calculations.

US PROJECTION (DASHBOARD)

~48,000

Example: projected US audience from the **original 2025 cohort** (e.g. 45k panelists x weighting)—~~not~~ scaled to 100k.

☐ Who is in the profile (sample window) ☐ What engagement we count (behavior window)

☐ Extra years used only to reach sample size

Decision flow

What the pipeline is doing conceptually—not every profile uses extended lookback.

1

Start with 2025

Look for panelists who meet the profile definition with sample and behavior both anchored to the study year (typically full-year 2025).

2

Count 2025 Crosswalk respondents

How many matched panelists qualified in the **study year alone**? If already $\geq$ **100,000** → **standard** path. If under → extended path (but note the original 2025 count for US projection).

3

If not, extend recruitment backward

Include panelists from earlier years who still qualify for the profile, until cumulative respondents $\geq$ 100,000.

4

Behavior filter unchanged

For every person in the behavioral sample—whether they joined in 2025 or were recruited from an earlier year—**only 2025 behaviors** are used for engagement and insights.

5

US projection = original year only

If 2025 started below **100,000**, the dashboard **US** figure is projected from that **original 2025 cohort**—not from the 100k behavioral sample. Crosswalk *n* may show $\geq$ 100k; *US* reflects real-world scale for the study year.

Summary

Profile IQ profiles are usually built from panelists active in **2025**, using only their **2025** digital behavior. When a niche audience cannot reach **100,000** people in 2025 alone, we widen *who* we recruit by pulling in qualified panelists from earlier years until the behavioral sample hits 100k—but we still only score their **2025** activity. The **US projection** on the profile stays anchored to the **original 2025 cohort** (however many that was), not to the 100k we use for behavior.

- Date range on the dashboard reflects the **behavior / study window** (e.g. 2025-01-01 – 2025-12-31).
- **Crosswalk respondents** can show $\geq$ 100k after extended recruitment (for modeling stability).
- **US projection** reflects the study-year audience when the profile initially had $<$ 100k—not the enlarged behavioral sample.
- Extended lookback is a **sample-size fix for behavior**, not a change to study year or US scale.

“We go back in time to get 100k for behavior, but US scale is always what 2025 alone actually represents—not the 100k headcount.”